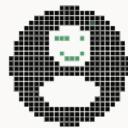


Ieuan King

Design Engineering & Product Design · Research, Evaluation & Design Systems · Brooklyn, NY

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Hi, I'm Ieuan. I'm a design engineer trained as an anthropologist, which is mostly a way of saying I go and find the problem before I design for it. Most of that has gone into human-in-the-loop AI for expert users: sitting with the people doing the work, watching where the task actually breaks, and deciding what an agent should and should not be trusted with. Most recently I co-founded Ubik Studio, where I owned the interfaces, the production front end, and the design systems underneath, plus the brand and the pitch narrative. Since then I have shipped six open-source projects across HITL components, agent evaluation, and developer tooling. I like watching the work before automating it, and designing so the human stays in the loop and the work stays legible.

EXPERIENCE

Independent

2026 - Present

akaOSS, Open-Source Human-in-the-Loop AI

- Run akaoss.dev as a one-person open-source studio: five projects on one thesis. A human-in-the-loop measurement family (HITL Kit, eval-kit, tag-kit) and a pair of Claude Code developer tools: Collapse for skill creation, Hologram for MCP control of Blender.
- Own design, front end, packaging, and docs end to end, and publish a findings feed of human-scored experiments alongside the paper that sets the thesis: Assist-Not-Complete.

Ubik Inc

2023 - 2026

Design Co-Founder

- Co-founded the company and led design for Ubik Studio, an AI research platform for professional researchers and knowledge workers, from design system through shipped web and signed desktop applications.
- Built the agentic surface across live agent status, streaming task states, batch review queues, evidence panels citing source pages, and Human Needed blocks where agents stop and hand the decision back.
- Worked in a small founding team and directly with design partners in academia, biotech, and law, turning interviews, session replays, and evaluation runs into shipped front-end fixes, features, and redesigns against real user problems, often the same week.
- Built the brand alongside it: visual identity, product copy, voice and terminology guidelines, and the pitch narrative that won the Startera accelerator, Fall 2023.

aka ieuan

2019 - Present

Producer, Creative Director

- 4M+ streams and 400K+ unique listeners in 174 countries under the yion alias. Now releasing as aka ieuan: 25 releases across four labels, performed internationally, and every cover, site, and visual for all of it built by me.

SELECTED OPEN-SOURCE PROJECTS

- **HITL Kit** - Nineteen React primitives for human-in-the-loop agentic UIs across six npm packages, distributed via the shadcn CLI. Tokens, variants, states, and accessibility handled at the primitive level.
- **eval-kit** - Measurement instrument for multi-step research agents. Human-scored rubrics, YAML suites, CI-gated regression checks, four adapters. Refuses LLM-as-judge by default.
- **Socket** - Browser studio for building audio plugins out of blocks. 54 DSP blocks, React and TypeScript over a C++ engine compiled to WebAssembly, so the preview runs the same code the exported plugin ships.
- **Trickle** - 47 pure-CSS text animation primitives for React. 42 ship as pure server components, median gzip under 1KB, zero animation runtime.
- **Hologram** - Live observability, guided skills, and an MCP surface for Blender to glTF pipelines. Python, MIT. Built alongside a 112-script procedural asset pipeline generating 89+ game-ready assets, where Three.js previews cut validation from roughly 30s to 1s.
- **tag-kit** - Structured annotation primitives for review workflows. Zero-dependency core plus a headless React layer, extracted from a content moderation tool.
- **Also shipped** - Collapse, a Claude Code skill-building framework with an MDX ingestor, trigger-phrase derivation, and a three-tier quality linter. akaVST, three JUCE audio plugins (VST3, AU, standalone) for macOS. akaCOVART, a generative album-art engine that syncs cover motion to a track. BodyLog, a mobile skin-tracking app designed and built end to end.

RESEARCH

- **An AI Measurement Problem** - The argument that drove how Ubik was evaluated and what shipped: the AI failure crisis is at root a measurement crisis. Makes the case for Assist-Not-Complete, evaluating AI on whether it assists a human without displacing them rather than on whether it finishes alone.
- **Lab log** - Reproducible, human-scored experiments on eval-kit suites. The current study uses distractor tasks where passing requires pushing back on unverifiable claims and future-dated sources, scoring refusal rather than compliance.

EDUCATION

SUNY Purchase · B.A., Anthropology & Media Studies · 2018 – 2022

Purchase, NY. Focus: human-computer interaction, datafication, algorithmic systems, digital capitalism.

SKILLS

Design & research Figma, product design, design systems, UX research, user interviews, usability testing, session-replay analysis, evaluation design, UX writing.

Frontend React, TypeScript, Next.js, Tailwind CSS, shadcn/ui, Electron, Three.js, component architecture, CI/testing.

AI & agents Claude Code, Cursor, agentic UI/UX, system prompt engineering, agent evaluation, MCP, RAG, tool-use patterns, Anthropic and OpenAI SDKs.

Also Blender, Godot 4, Ableton, PostHog.